DR. NIKITA MEHTA

VENEERS: READ THIS FIRST

Why I don't do loads of veneers, and how to know if they're right for you



TWO VENEERS AND COMPOSITE · MY OWN CASE

Veneers are a highly skilled treatment, and done for the right person they can last a long time and look natural. They also mean shaping your own teeth, and that can't be undone. I've done veneers for a long time, but I don't do loads of them, because I believe they need real case selection. This guide is what I'd want you to know first.

01
IS IT VENEERS YOU WANT

02
WHAT DECIDES THE PLAN

03
CHOOSING WELL

STEP 1

VENEERS, *or a change?*

DR. NM

Most people who ask me for veneers want something more specific: teeth that are whiter, straighter, less worn, or a smile that looks younger. Sometimes veneers are the best way there. Often something gentler comes first.

BEFORE VENEERS, I'D ALWAYS LOOK AT

1 WHITENING

Your own teeth can change colour and veneers can't, so whitening comes first in every veneer plan I make.

2 STRAIGHTENING

Clear aligners can move teeth into a better position, which means less shaping for veneers, or sometimes no veneers at all.

3 BONDING

For chips, small gaps and worn edges, composite adds to the tooth without taking any away.

> WORTH KNOWING
>
> Many of my smiles mix all of these. Two veneers where the teeth need them, bonding and whitening everywhere else.

STEP 2

WHAT DECIDES *the plan*

A first look gives us an idea, not a plan. The detail decides it.

1 YOUR BITE

How your teeth meet when you chew, speak and close. If someone wants long teeth and their bite won't allow it, the veneers are likely to chip or break.

2 YOUR GUMS

Healthy gums come first. They frame the smile and support the veneers.

3 HOW MUCH TOOTH YOU HAVE

I aim to keep as much of your natural tooth as possible.

4 THE COLOUR UNDERNEATH

It affects how thick the veneers need to be.

5 HOW MANY TEETH

Sometimes two veneers are right. Sometimes it's more.





ALIGNMENT, TWO VENEERS AND BONDING





TWO VENEERS AND BONDING · 10 YEARS ON

STEP 3

BEFORE *you decide*

DR. NM

1 SHAPING IS PERMANENT

Once a tooth is prepared, it will always need a veneer or something similar.

2 VENEERS NEED CHECKING

I see veneer patients every six months, because the bite and how the teeth work together matter so much.

3 THEY WON'T LAST FOREVER

Your teeth and gums change with age. Veneers can chip, come loose or need replacing over time.

4 THE NERVE

Shaping a tooth puts some stress on the nerve. Most settle. Occasionally a tooth needs root canal treatment later.

5 GRINDING AND CLENCHING

These put extra force on veneers. If you do either, we'd talk about protecting them.

"I hardly ever try to match a celebrity's smile, because I've never seen it work well."

CHOOSING WELL

CHOOSING YOUR DENTIST *for veneers*

DR. NM

1 LOOK AT THEIR OWN WORK, CLOSE UP AND OVER TIME

Photos on the day of fitting show you the start. Photos five or ten years later show you whether it lasts.

2 ASK HOW THEY DECIDE

In my experience, highly technical veneers take careful planning, and more isn't always better.

3 ASK ABOUT THE OTHER OPTIONS

A good dentist will tell you when veneers aren't the answer.

4 ASK ABOUT THE TRY-IN

You should see and test the design, in temporaries, before anything is fitted for good.





VENEERS, CROWN AND BONDING · 5 YEARS ON

LONG TERM

LOOKING AFTER *veneers*

DR. NM

1 BRUSH TWICE A DAY AND CLEAN BETWEEN YOUR TEETH EVERY DAY

2 KEEP YOUR SIX-MONTHLY CHECKS AND HYGIENE VISITS

3 DON'T USE YOUR FRONT TEETH AS TOOLS, OR BITE VERY HARD THINGS WITH THEM

4 WEAR YOUR NIGHT GUARD, IF ONE HAS BEEN MADE FOR YOU

If you're already thinking about veneers, the most useful thing you can bring to a consultation is a clear sense of what you'd like to change, and what you'd hate to lose.

TALK IT THROUGH

If you'd like to talk about your smile, book a consultation with me through my website.

BOOK A CONSULTATION

DRNIKITAMEHTA.COM

KEEP READING

I write *The Deliberate Clinician*, a free weekly letter on how I think about smiles, ageing and the work behind a natural result.

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Dr Nikita Mehta BDS MSc (UK) · GDC 76510 · Private treatment at West House Dental, Pinner. This guide is general information, not advice for your teeth. Your options depend on a proper examination. Photos are my own cases, shown with consent.